

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Muhammad Khawaja

Address: 22A York Road Cheam SM2 6HH

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I write in support of application DM2025/01591. The proposal represents an important and appropriate community facility that will serve local residents while operating in a controlled and predictable manner.

A place of worship has already been operating locally for several years at a nearby location without causing any significant or sustained highway safety or parking issues. This demonstrates that the existing level of demand can be accommodated within the local area, and that the congregation attends in a responsible and orderly way.

Concerns raised regarding the Transport Statement appear to reflect a theoretical worst-case scenario rather than typical real-world conditions. In practice, attendance at places of worship is staggered, of limited duration, and concentrated at specific times rather than continuously throughout the day. Many attendees are local residents who walk, share transport, or use public transport, which reduces overall parking demand.

Importantly, the provision of a dedicated and properly managed facility is likely to improve the current situation rather than worsen it. A permanent location allows for clearer coordination, responsible management of arrivals and departures, and the opportunity to encourage sustainable transport options such as walking, car-sharing, and public transport.

The surrounding area already experiences peak parking demand during school drop-off and pick-up times regardless of this application. The proposed use would not materially alter the overall character of the area, and its activity patterns are predictable and manageable.

Places of worship provide significant public and social benefits. They strengthen community cohesion, provide educational and charitable services, support young people and families, and contribute positively to the wellbeing of local residents.

On balance, the proposal represents a reasonable and appropriate use that serves a clear community need without causing unacceptable harm.

For these reasons, I respectfully request that Sutton Council approve application DM2025/01591.